

Μόνιμος ὁ Συρακόσιος

Monimus of Syracuse and the Cynic Rejection of Convention

eul_aid: fpu

Period: Κλασική Classical
Dialect: Ἀττική Attic (phi, frg)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία Philosophy
Format: Πραγματεία Treatise
Affiliation: Cynic

Monimus of Syracuse was a Cynic philosopher active in the 4th century BCE. Originally a household slave in Corinth, he reportedly feigned madness to gain his freedom, a story that aligns with the Cynic rejection of social conventions. He became a pupil of the famous Cynic Diogenes and was also associated with Crates of Thebes. Some accounts suggest he first studied with the Pythagorean Philolaus, but this connection is less certain.

His writings are lost and known only through later references. He is credited with a treatise On Impulses and a poetic work of Exhortatory Philosophy. According to modern scholars, the titles and surviving fragments indicate his style mixed serious philosophical argument with satirical humor, which was characteristic of the Cynic school.

Monimus is a minor but historically attested figure in early Cynicism. His significance lies in his association with major Cynic thinkers and as an example of the philosophy's spread. His few surviving sayings, such as "All is vanity," emphasize core Cynic themes: the worthlessness of mere opinion and the pursuit of virtue through a simple, self-sufficient life. His personal story, from slavery to philosophy, came to exemplify the Cynic ideal of finding true freedom by abandoning societal norms.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα · Cynic Maxims and Sayings · 2 passages

Other Cynic Authors

- Ἀντισθένης ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Antisthenes of Athens I · 1 work
- Ἀντισθένης ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Antisthenes of Athens II · 2 works
- Βίων ὁ Βορυσθενίτης · Bion of Borysthenes · 2 works
- Κράτης ὁ Θεβαῖος · Crates of Thebes I · 1 work
- Δημόναξ ὁ Κύπριος · Demonax of Cyprus · 1 work
- Διογένης ὁ Σινωπεύς · Diogenes of Sinope · 1 work
- Διοτογένης ὁ φιλόσοφος · Diotogenes the Philosopher · 1 work
- Οἰνόμαος ὁ Γαδαρεύς · Oenomaus of Gadara · 1 work
- Σεκούνδος ὁ Σιωπηλός · Secundus the Silent · 2 works

- Τέλης ὁ Μεγαρεύς · Teles of Megara · 8 works